

UNITED STATES
DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR
FISH AND WILDLIFE SERVICE

1953

ANNUAL REPORT

KOTZEBUE-YUKON-KUSKOKWIM AREA

Washington
Juneau
Seattle

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STREAM SURVEYS

A few streams were surveyed this season in an attempt to locate some of the major spawning streams of the various species and to pick out streams to use as criteria to judge runs and escapement of species.

? In the Yukon drainage, the rivers surveyed include sections of the Chatanika, Goodpaster, Clearwater, Little Salcha, Salcha, and Tanana.

For a future gauge of escapement, the only king salmon stream surveyed which appeared to be an important spawning stream was the Salcha River. This river has many miles of spawning gravels and an aerial survey would be most practical. The run of king salmon in the Salcha River this season appeared about the 10th of July and lasted until the end of July. The Salcha River is one of the spawning streams used by earlier runs of king salmon.

As index streams for chin salmon in the Yukon system, the Salcha or Clearwater Rivers would be good streams. The Salcha River had a run of chin salmon from about the middle of July to well into August this year. The Clearwater had a good run of chins in late September.

The Clearwater River also had a good run of coho salmon when surveyed in late September.

The low concentration of fish in streams in this area when spawning conditions appear to be optimum, can not be considered poor seeding. Streams which appear suitable to spawning salmon during the spawning season may undergo severe conditions in the winter or at break up which would make it impossible for eggs and fry to survive.

✓
couldn't find #3
✓

1954
OK WEIRS OPERATED

Date of operation not known

A grayling weir in the Little Salcha River, constructed by Federal Aid personnel at Fairbanks, was put into operation to count salmon this season. Unfortunately, the few miles of available spawning gravel of this river were not heavily utilized this season and only 47 chin salmon were counted through the weir. It is possible that a late run of coho salmon spawned in this stream after fall high water made the weir operation impossible.

If a weir were to be used another season to obtain an accurate count of fish as an estimate of seeding and escapement, I would suggest it be built on the Salcha or Clearwater Rivers.

STREAM IMPROVEMENT AND PREDATOR CONTROL

No stream improvement or predator control work was carried on this season.

PATROL

No enforcement patrol was made of the commercial fishing on the lower Yukon during the commercial king salmon season.

A. Vessels used.

June 9 and 10 an outboard skiff was chartered to contact the Alatom Trading Company's saltery at Fish Village.

No service vessels were used this season.

B. Aircraft.

A two place Aeronca belonging to the Law Enforcement Division was used for patrol of the commercial fishing on the upper Yukon River. This aircraft was also used to make surveys of the personal use fisheries of this area.